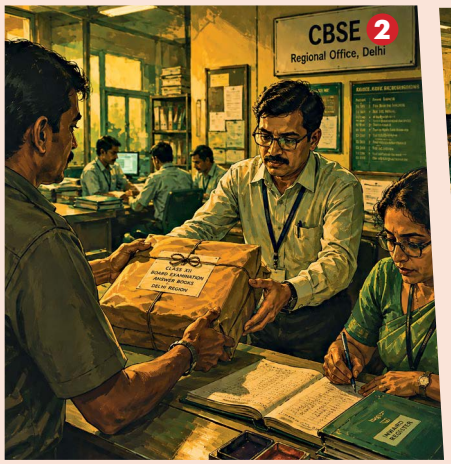
HOW ON-SCREEN MARKING WORKS

In this digital evaluation system, answer books are scanned and uploaded to a secure online portal, where human examiners mark them on a computer screen, with totals calculated automatically



Student writes paper answer book

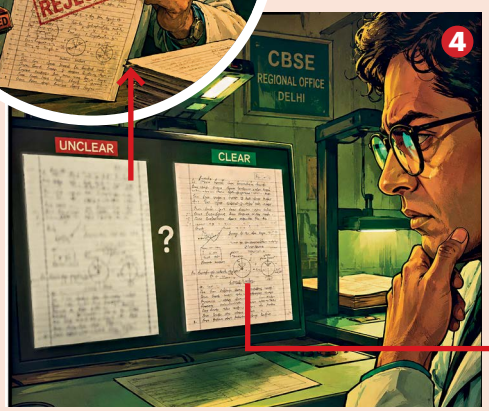


Answer book reaches CBSE Regional Office

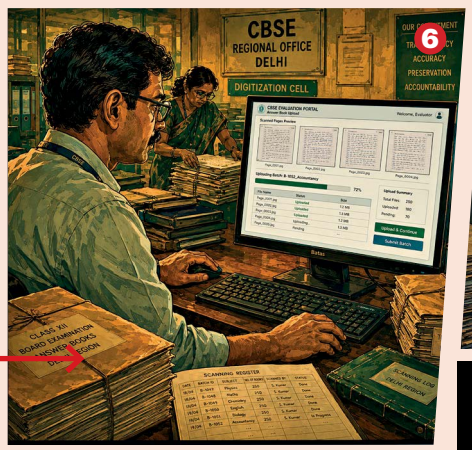


It is scanned using non-destructive book or lamp scanners





Scan quality is checked. If it is unclear or blurred, the evaluator rejects copy (*see no. 5*)



Scanned images are uploaded to the evaluation portal



Human examiner marks question-wise on screen. System automatically totals the marks and submits, after which results are compiled

THE PERILS OF HASTE

Meanwhile, students who remain unconvinced by their marks are filing for verification and re-evaluation through a window that opened on June 2 and closes on June 6, even as OSM, pitched as a faster, cleaner, more efficient way to grade, has drawn some of the heaviest public criticism.

OSM was meant to be a modernisation initiative. Students still wrote their papers by hand, what changed was the evaluation layer. Answer books were scanned at regional offices, uploaded to a secure portal and marked question by question by human examiners on screen, with totals calculated automatically.

When the CBSE announced the nationwide rollout in February, it listed 10 benefits and called the system an "environmentally sustainable digital evaluation" process. "The concept itself is sound and aligns with global trends," says Professor V. Ramgopal Rao, group vice-chancellor of BITS Pilani. "The issue appears to be not the idea but the implementation."

Educators had flagged the gaps—moderation, dipping results, untrained evaluators and shaky digital infrastructure—during consultative meetings, and the warnings proved prescient. A CBSE governing body meeting in June 2025 had explicitly suggested that OSM be rolled out only after pilots in some subjects across regional offices. That advice was set aside.

Instead, the CBSE ran a three-day dry run in January with just five Delhi schools and pressed ahead. Even the dry run was not reassuring. Participants documented dozens of faults on day one. A second report on the third day listed at least 36 concerns.

Jyoti Gupta, director of The Shri Ram Universal School in Ghaziabad, and director-principal, K.R. Mangalam World School, GK-II, Delhi, argues the sequencing was wrong. "It should have been done in a phased manner, with a

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